

three minutes when an indentation error in their algorithm caused it to interpret market conditions incorrectly. What was intended as "if A and B then sell" became "if A then [if B then sell]" due to a misplaced indent, resulting in unintended trades.

?? **Pro Tip:** *In professional trading environments like Citadel Securities and Jane Street, developers use automated code formatters like "Black" to ensure consistent indentation and formatting. This eliminates an entire class of potential bugs. Before implementing any new trading algorithm, run it through an automated formatter and linting tool. This simple step, which takes seconds, has saved trading firms millions by catching subtle indentation and formatting issues before they affect live trading.*

PEP 8: The Python Style Guide

PEP 8 is the official style guide for Python code. Following these conventions makes your code more readable and easier to maintain—critical for trading systems that might need to be modified quickly during volatile markets.

Key PEP 8 recommendations include:

- Use 4 spaces per indentation level (not tabs)
- Limit lines to 79 characters for code, 72 for comments
- Use blank lines to separate logical sections
- Use descriptive variable names (e.g., `moving_average_period` instead of `m`)

```
1. # Good PEP 8 style
2. def calculate_rsi(prices, period=14):
3.     """
4.     Calculate the Relative Strength Index for a price series.
5.
6.     Args:
7.         prices: List of closing prices
```